

22

for

Sanjana

22 Years of You. 22 Reasons I'm Grateful You Exist.

March 22, 2026

With love, from Paartha

*For the girl who is full of life,
who made me remember what it felt like to be alive.*

*She did not fix me.
She just stood there being herself,
and somehow that was enough
to remind me I was worth fixing.*

The Letter

Dear Sanjana,

Happy Birthday.

I don't know where to start. I've been sitting here since 2 AM trying to figure out the perfect first line, the perfect opening, the perfect way to tell you everything I feel. But there is no perfect way. So I'm just going to write.

You're turning 22 on the 22nd. Even the calendar couldn't help but rhyme with you.

22 years ago today, you were born. I didn't know. I was probably at home, sitting on my amma's lap, probably crying for milk or something. Somewhere in this universe, on this exact day, God finished His masterpiece. Like a potter who finally got the clay right — He made you. Full of life, full of fire, full of something I still can't name.

I wasn't there. I didn't see you open your eyes for the first time. I didn't hear your first cry. But that cry? That was the sound of my future beginning, even though I didn't know it yet.

Enaku appove theriyaathu nee yaarunu, nee eppdi irupanu, un sirippu eppadi irukkumnu. But somewhere in this universe, you existed. And that was enough to change everything.

22 years later, I'm writing this letter to you at 2 AM in Bangalore, 100 kilometers away from you, with a heart that has absolutely no plan to stop loving you.

I am, by all measures, a mess.

But I am a mess who loves you. And somehow, that feels like the most important thing about me.

You know what kills me? We were in the same school. Vijay Millennium. Same corridors, same terrible canteen, same compound wall, same lunch break timing. I was in 11th when you were in 9th. 12th when you were in 10th. Two floors away. Two years younger. A completely different universe inside the same building.

I walked past you. Maybe a hundred times. And I felt nothing. NOTHING. How? How did I walk past you and not feel the earth shift?

Nee un anna Jagan-a paakka class-ku varuva. I didn't know. Nee velliya iruppa, kutti size la — I didn't notice. What a waste, Sanjana. What an absolute waste of two beautiful years.

Sometimes I imagine going back to 2017 — to that classroom, that corridor — and just LOOKING. Looking more carefully. Because somewhere in that crowd of students in blue uniforms, there was a girl who would one day make a boy in Bangalore write this letter at 2 AM for her 22nd birthday.

But we found each other eventually. And maybe that's how it was supposed to be. Maybe we both needed to go through everything we went through before we were ready.

And then 2024 happened.

Jagan was already my friend. We used to video call — me, Ashwin, Alister, Jagan. Your brother was in my life for years. He was the bridge, but he didn't know it yet.

One day something shifted. Maybe it was hearing your name on a call. Maybe it was a Snapchat story I accidentally saw. Maybe it was Jagan showing his phone and you were in the background. I don't remember the exact moment. It was something quiet, something small — like a single pixel changing on a massive screen. You wouldn't notice. But the whole picture was different because of it.

And then we talked. The first time we actually spoke — I was shocked. Nee ivvalavu talkative-a iruppa nu naane expect pannala. I thought you'd be quiet, reserved. But you opened up. You talked. You laughed. You roasted me. That first conversation felt like someone opened a window in a room I'd been sitting in too long with the curtains drawn.

That day I realized — I wasn't just talking to Jagan's sister. Naan yaarukitta-yo pesuran — yaaru ennoda life-a maatha poraangalo, avangakitta.

And you did. You changed everything.

When someone asks me why I like you — I don't have an answer. I swear, I don't.

It's not because you're beautiful — you are beautiful, but that's not it. It's not because you're Jagan's sister — he's my best friend, but that's not why. It's not because you're funny, or because you're full of life, or because of anything I can name.

It's something deeper. Unna paathaa enaku etho aaguthudi, puriyuthaa? That's what I told you and I meant every word. I can't even explain it to myself, so how would I explain it to you?

You asked me once — "appo yaaro orutharai love panrathukaaga en mela love panra?" No. There are so many people in this world. My heart chose only one.

I don't have a reason. And maybe that's the most honest kind of love — the kind that doesn't need one.

But let me tell you what I see. What I notice. Because you probably don't know this but —

I notice which days you post on Snapchat and which days you don't. I notice when your status has a new song and I listen to the whole thing. I notice when your brother posts something with you in it and I screenshot it. I notice when you use "apdiyaa" vs "hmm" — and I know which one means you're interested.

I noticed you had a long day once because your snap was a ceiling photo instead of a mirror selfie.

I memorized the names of all eight of your college friends. Anu, Sindhu, Maithri / Maithreyi, Harini, Haritha, Ezhil, Hari. I memorize your Snapchat schedule. You memorize anatomy. Firmware and physiology — we couldn't be more different.

But when you love someone, your eyes become detectives and your heart becomes a filing cabinet that stores every detail. Because it matters. You do.

You sing on Snap sometimes and think nobody notices. I notice. Many may notice but I'm the biggest fan!

You play soapy football with zero warmup and no regrets. You fall down, you get hurt, you complain about body pain — and then you do it again.

You stay up till 5 AM and still function. You went on a trip with 8 friends and functioned on 2 hours of sleep. You threaten violence while smiling. You enter a room and the room wakes up — lights get brighter, conversations get louder. Some people carry their own weather. You carry summer — even in the rain.

You are stubborn in the most beautiful way. You have neat handwriting, color-coded notes, and you probably judged people who didn't use margins. I'm big fan of whatever that you like or reshare on Instagram!

You told me something once that I will never forget. "Enaku eppadi irundaalum naan veliya perusaa sollikka maaten. Enaku ipdi irukku apdi irukkunnu naan openly yaarkittayum solla maaten."

I heard you. And I see you.

You're the girl who feels everything but shows nothing. Who carries sadness like a secret. Who lets only two people discover when she's not okay. You say "I'm fine" but your voice changes. You say "adhellam okay" and change the topic. You're not cold — you're careful. There's a difference.

I want to be the next person on that list. You don't have to open up tomorrow. Or next week. Or even next year. I'm not going anywhere.

Masks get heavy, kanna. And you deserve someone who says "kazhattidu da, en kitta mask ellam venaam." That someone is me. You can be emotionally naked with me I don't

care about the composed version. I want the real one. The one who cries when she's hurt, laughs when she's happy, and throws things when she's angry. Give me all of it. All of you. That's the only gift I'll ever ask for.

And then there are the calls.

March 16. Night 9:14. I called you. FaceTime. You didn't pick up.

And in the silence between the last ring and the voicemail, I lived an entire life — one where you picked up and we talked until your battery died, one where you texted back "2 mins" and I waited like it was Christmas morning, one where you never called back and I learned what missing someone who's still alive feels like.

Then — you called back.

And every imagined life collapsed into the only one that mattered. The one where I hear your voice.

We spoke for 42 minutes. About nothing. About mangoes that cost 400 rupees. About a teacher who yelled at me for smiling. About a friend whose heart was quietly breaking. 42 minutes of nothing that meant everything.

And when you said goodbye — "Nalla thookam varanum. REM sleep ellam poittu superaa ezhanum. Entha kavalaiyum padakkoodathu. Surususuppa irukanum. Erumai maari laesiyaa irukkakoodathu."

Doctor mode ON even in saying goodnight. I was dying.

You didn't say "sweet dreams." You prescribed me quality sleep. And that's infinitely better. Her voice is the only sound that makes silence feel like a loss.

At the end I said — "I am so so so happy that you called me, I will be sleeping peacefully." One call from you = peaceful sleep. That's the power you have over me.

Next time — just pick up da. My heart can't take the waiting.

You know what my favorite thing in the world is? When I say "I love you" and you say "Ey saavu adippein!"

Every. Single. Time.

Because I've decoded you. When you say "saavu adippein" — you're actually saying "I heard you and I don't know how to respond because I feel something too but I will never admit it so I'm going to threaten violence instead."

Am I right? Don't answer. I know I'm right.

You told me — "un love ellam dustbin la pottukkoo." But you stayed on that call for 42 minutes. You wished me REM sleep. You told me not to be lazy like an erumai. You asked me if I ate. You told me to put thailam on my pain. I said "Thailatham poodu" and you said "adhu sari aagaathu" — classic. Even at fourteen, you probably told your mom the same thing. "Amma, athu ellam sari aagaathu!"

She says she doesn't care. But she asked if I ate. She says she doesn't care. But she prescribed me REM sleep. She says she doesn't care. But she stayed on the call for 42 minutes. She says she doesn't care.

And I've never felt more cared for in my entire life.

That's love, Sanjana. That's YOUR version of love. And I'll take it over a thousand "I love you too"s.

Keep threatening me. I'll keep loving you.

And then there's the water bottle. On a call, out of nowhere, you said — "Naan water bottle eduthutu vara marandhuthen." I laughed so hard. You can talk about the most serious things one minute and fight about water bottles the next. Doctor aagaporavaa water bottle kooda marandhutuva? That's what makes you extraordinary. Brilliant at the big things, adorably chaotic at the small things.

You text me good morning — four hours later. I tell you you're beautiful — you ask if I ate. I send you love — you throw it in the dustbin. So throw it in the dustbin. I'll fish it out and say it again tomorrow.

Before all the darkness — I was like you. I used to laugh without thinking. I used to be the guy who's always smiling, always talking, always jumping into things without fear. That boy doesn't exist anymore. But when I see you — I see him. I see who I used to be.

You are the version of me that the world couldn't break. You remind me that the boy I buried still breathes. And for that alone, I love you.

I was surviving before you. After you — I started living. It's not that you saved me. It's that you reminded me I was worth saving.

She did not fix me. She just stood there being herself, and somehow that was enough to remind me I was worth fixing.

Now let me tell you about the gifts. Because every single one has a reason.

That crescent moon necklace — I chose the crescent because the full moon is what everyone loves. But you? You're the sliver that makes people look up and wonder. Not everything needs to be full to be whole. Not everything needs to be loud to be heard. I trapped real flowers in the curve of the moon because I wanted to give you something

that would never die. Like the way I feel every time you speak. Wear it close to your chest. That's where I want to be.

That bracelet with real flowers inside — flowers die. That's their tragedy. You receive them, you smile, and within days they're gone. But I didn't want my love for you to be like that. I wanted it to last. So I found a way to trap real flowers inside resin, frozen in time, and turned them into something you can wear on your wrist every day. That's what you are to me — a moment of beauty that I refuse to let fade. Frozen in time. Unchanging. Permanent.

You told me your friends Anu and Ezhil gave you flowers. First time in your life someone gave you flowers. And I was gutted. IT WAS SUPPOSED TO BE ME. But then you said — "atleast oru flowers kidaikira alavukku kooda naan illama poitene, oruthan kooda flower kodukala.". You are worth an entire rose garden. Not one bouquet — the entire garden. Every color, every petal, every thorn included. I'm sorry I wasn't the first to give you flowers. But I'll be the one who never stops.

That big teddy bear — un maadu bommai pakkathula vechu. The teddy will keep your maadu bommai company.

That little teddy — un bag la pottukko. Wherever you go, it'll be like I'm always with you. It won't talk back. It won't say "I love you" every five minutes like I do. It won't irritate you. But it'll be there — in your bag, in your room, in your life — as a small reminder that somewhere in Bangalore, oru paithiyakaran unnai pathi 24 hours yosichiittu irukkaan.

That phone cover — I got it customized with that cartoon girl and your name on it. Because I want the first thing you see every morning when you pick up your phone to be something that was made with love. Un phone cover kazhatti puthusu potta, naan hurt aaiduven. Consider yourself warned.

Your brother is one of my closest friends. I've known him for years. And the whole time — his sister was the person who'd change my life. What are the odds? I think the universe has a sense of humor. It put the love of my life in the family of my best friend, in the same school I went to — and then made me wait until 2024 to actually speak to her.

Anu, Haritha, Sindhu, Maithri, Harini, Ezhil, Hari — these are the people who get to see you every day. Who go on trips with you, who play soapy football with you, who know your mood swings before you even say anything. I'm jealous of them. Obviously. But also — I'm grateful for them. Because they take care of you when I can't. They make you laugh when I'm not there to try. Tell your friends I said thank you. For keeping you safe, for keeping you happy, for keeping you YOU.

I want to be part of that world someday. Not to change it — just to exist in it. Quietly, like one more person who cares about you. One more name in your phone. One more voice that asks "saapittiyaa?"

Enna kalyanam pannikkiriya? Naan unna nallaa paathuppen. Raani maari paathuppen.

I know you probably rolled your eyes reading that. But I meant it.

Not in the "put you on a pedestal" way — but in the "make sure your coffee is ready when you come home from a 36-hour hospital shift" way. In the "sit quietly next to you while you study because even your silence is my favorite sound" way.

You're going to heal people. And I just want to be the person who takes care of you while you take care of the world. That's a promise.

In the morning I dream of, you are there — hair messy, eyes half-closed, telling me to shut up because it's too early. I bring coffee. You complain it's too sweet. I kiss your forehead. You complain about that too. But you drink the coffee. And you let me stay. That's the morning I'm building, one letter at a time.

I am jealous of the air that gets to live inside your lungs. I am jealous of the pillow that knows the weight of your head at 2 AM. I am jealous of the stethoscope that gets to hear every heartbeat I would die for. I am jealous of the songs that get to be your background music when I can't be your foreground. But most of all — I am jealous of the you who doesn't know how extraordinary she is.

I wish I could lend you my eyes for a day. You'd finally understand why I can't look away.

I don't choose to think about you. It just happens. The way the earth doesn't choose to orbit the sun. The way rivers don't choose to find the sea. It's gravity. You are my gravity. Falling. Toward you. Always.

You said — "Enaku vanthu adhula vanthu kashtam." You worry about me. You think my feelings are a burden. But Sanjana — you are the lightest thing I carry. Everything else is heavy. You are not.

I don't know what we'll become. But right now, on this day — I love you. Completely. Without reason. Without condition.

You're turning 22. Here are 22 reasons why you deserve everything:

1. You make me want to wake up in the morning.
2. Your laugh can cure things medicine can't.
3. You play soapy football with zero warmup and no regrets.
4. You care about your patients deeply — even the ones who scare you.

5. You stayed on the call even when you said "dustbin la pottukko."
6. "REM sleep ellam poittu super-a ezhanum" — you care without admitting you care.
7. You are stubborn in the most beautiful way.
8. You went on a trip with 8 friends and functioned on 2 hours of sleep.
9. You have a maadu bommai and that's adorable.
10. You sing on snap sometimes and think nobody notices. I notice.
11. You are studying to literally save lives.
12. You carry other people's pain even when they don't ask you to.
13. You can read Tamil text — most people our age can't.
14. You think you're not worth flowers but you deserve entire gardens.
15. You call me "lOOsu" and "psycho" but never hang up.
16. You are emotionally intelligent in ways you don't realize.
17. Your existence makes Bangalore feel less lonely.
18. You remind me of who I used to be — full of life.
19. You don't need anyone but you let people love you anyway.
20. You are strong in the way that doesn't need applause.
21. You make the ordinary feel extraordinary.
22. You are Sanjana. And that is reason enough.

Nee indha letter-a padikkum bothu, un birthday morning irukklaam, illa night irukklaam, illa niraiya naal kalichi nee itha padikalam illa enga-yaavadhu un friends kooda irukklaam. But wherever you are, whoever you're with — know that there is a stupid firmware engineer in Bangalore who is thinking about you RIGHT NOW. Not just now — every second of every day.

That big teddy bear — un maadu bommai pakkathula vechu. That little teddy — un bag la pottukko. That bracelet — un kaila podu. That crescent moon necklace — un kazhuthula podu. That phone cover — un phone la use pannu.

And this letter and these 22 poems — read them slowly. One per day. Or all at once at 5 AM after a trip. However you want.

"I just want to buy the entire universe for you and just keep it with you." Naan appove sonne. Aana nee yosichchu paaru — universe vaangarthu yenna? Nee thaana en universe. So technically, I already have what I want.

Just know that every word was written by a boy who loves you without reason, without condition, and without any plan to stop.

I love you — even the version of you that was just one day old. I love you — the version that plays soapy football and complains about body pain. I love you — the version that says "dustbin la pottukko" but never hangs up. I love you — the version that exists when

nobody's watching. I love you because when I look at you, I remember who I used to be before the world broke me. And that? That's the greatest gift anyone has ever given me.

I love you, Sanjana. Without reason, without condition, without end. Avvalavu than.

Happy 22nd Birthday, kannu. 22 looks beautiful on you. Everything does.

Un mela yarum anbu kaati vidakoodaadhu enbathil — konjam peraasai than.

Unnai kadithathal sandhitha naan — letters are my love language, and you are my language.

Forever and irritatingly,

Partha

P.S. Enna kalyanam pannikkiriya? Raani maari paathuppen.

P.P.S. "Saavu adippEn" nu sollaadhe. Sirichiduvu.

P.P.P.S. I love you. Dustbin-la pottukkoo if you want. I'll just write another 22.

1. She Is the Reason (Without a Reason)

She is the reason I forgot
that I was looking for a reason.
She walked in like weather —
not an event, but a season.

I did not choose to love her.
Something older than my mind,
something wired into my ribs,
already knew what it would find.

They ask me why.
I search and search
and come back with
only this:

She is not the answer
to a question I was asking.
She is the question
I never knew I had.

2. She Is the Reason I Forgot to Be Sad

She called me at 9 PM on a Sunday
and I forgot that I was sad.

Not in the way medicine works —
slow, measured, chemical —
but in the way sunrise works.

One moment it's dark.
The next, there's light everywhere
and you can't remember
what the darkness even looked like.

She talked about Madurai,
about soapy football,
about a cow stuffed toy
she still keeps on her bed —

and I forgot that I was sad.

She didn't try to fix me.
She just existed.

And that was enough.

3. Before You, After You

Before you:
nights that lasted centuries.
After you:
42-minute calls that feel like seconds.

Before you:
every song was about loss.
After you:
every song is about what's possible.

Before you:
I forgot what my laugh sounded like.
After you:
I laugh at my own jokes just to practice.

Before you:
I was surviving.
After you:
I started living.

It's not that you saved me.
It's that you reminded me
I was worth saving.

4. The Mirror

You are my younger self
wearing someone else's face —
full of life, unafraid,
running through the world
like it owes you a good time
and you intend to collect.

I was like you once.
Before the sadness.
Before the pills.
Before I forgot how to smile
without a reason.

You remind me
that the boy I buried
still breathes.

5. Gravity

I don't choose to think about you.
It just happens.

The way the earth
doesn't choose to orbit the sun.
The way rivers
don't choose to find the sea.

It's gravity.
You are my gravity.

And I could fight it —
resist, build walls,
pretend I'm fine —

but why would I fight
the one force in my life
that makes me feel
like I'm exactly
where I'm supposed to be?

Falling.
Toward you.
Always.

6. Moon Girl

She is not the sun.
The sun demands you look.
The sun insists.

She is the moon —
soft, silver, showing up
without announcement,
lighting paths
for people who are lost
and don't know it yet.

I was lost.
She showed up.
I found my way
by following her glow.

7. The Moon Necklace

I chose the crescent
because the full moon
is what everyone loves.

But you —
you're the sliver
that makes people look up
and wonder.

Not everything needs to be full
to be whole.
Not everything needs to be loud
to be heard.

I trapped real flowers
in the curve of the moon
because I wanted to give you
something that would never die.

Like the way I feel
every time you speak.

Wear it close to your chest.
That's where I want to be.

8. Flowers That Stay

I put flowers in glass
and glass on your wrist
because I wanted to prove
that some things refuse to die.

Not the flowers in gardens
that bloom and forget —
but the ones that are caught
at their most beautiful
and told:
stay.

Like this feeling.
Caught. Preserved.
Refusing to wilt
even when the world says
all things end.

9. The Flowers Inside the Bracelet

I put real flowers
inside a bracelet
because I wanted to give you
something that was once alive
but would never die.

Like a memory
that refuses to fade.

Like a boy in Bangalore
who picked up the phone one day,
heard a girl's voice,
and decided —

this is it.
This is the reason
I kept going.

She was coming.
She was always coming.

I just had to survive
long enough
to find her.

And I did.

10. Her Laugh

Her laugh enters a room
before she does —
a sound that rewrites
the chemical composition
of the air.

Someone should study this.
Someone should write a paper:
"The Effect of One Girl's Laughter
on a Boy Who Forgot
What Joy Was."

Conclusion:
No cure was needed.
She laughed.
He healed.

11. Her Voice

She says "go sleep"
and I hear a lullaby.

She says "I'll hit you"
and I hear a love song.

She says "REM sleep ellam"
and I hear a prescription
written by someone
who cares more than
she'll ever admit.

Her voice is the only sound
that makes silence
feel like a loss.

12. She Doesn't Know

She doesn't know
what she looks like
to me.

Not the mirror version.
Not the selfie version.
Not the posed, filtered,
carefully-composed version.

The version that plays football
with no warmup
and falls and laughs
and calls it a day.

The version that stays up
till 5 AM
and still functions.

The version that threatens violence
while smiling.

That version.
The real one.
The extraordinary one.

I wish I could lend her
my eyes for a day.
She'd finally understand
why I can't look away.

13. The Things I Notice

You probably don't know this but —

I notice which days
you post on Snapchat
and which days you don't.

I notice when your status
has a new song
and I listen to the whole thing.

I notice when your brother
posts something with you in it
and I screenshot it.

I notice when you use
"apdiyaa" vs "hmm"
and I know which one means
you're interested.

I notice everything, Sanjana.

Because when you love someone,
your eyes become detectives
and your heart becomes
a filing cabinet
that stores every detail.

Because it matters.
You do.

14. Madurai Without Me

You went to Madurai
with eight friends.

You checked out early.
Plans went sideways.
You laughed anyway.

And I wasn't there.

I heard the whole story
through the phone
and I painted it in my mind —

you and Anu and Sindhu
and Maithri and Harini
and Ezhil and Hari and Haritha.

One day,
maybe the headcount is nine.

Until then,
I'll live inside your stories.

And that's enough.

15. What I Mean When I Say I Love You

When I say I love you,
you say — throw it in the dustbin.

When I say I love you,
you say — saavu adippein.

But when I say I love you,
what I mean is:

I noticed you had a long day
because your snap was a ceiling photo
instead of a mirror selfie.

I mean:
I memorized the names
of all eight of your college friends.

I mean:
you are the only anchor point
in a life that keeps trying
to drift away.

So throw it in the dustbin.
I'll fish it out
and say it again tomorrow.

16. The Engineer and the Doctor

You study the human body.
I study circuits and code.

You learn to heal people.
I learn to make machines work.

You hold a stethoscope.
I hold a soldering iron.

You memorize anatomy.
I memorize your Snapchat schedule.

We couldn't be more different.
Firmware and physiology.

And yet —
in the space between
your world and mine,

there's a frequency
that only we can hear.

And you, Sanjana,
are the strongest signal
I have ever received.

17. Doctor

She studies the mind
so she can fix what breaks.
She doesn't know
she already fixed mine
just by existing.

Someday she'll wear a white coat
and a stethoscope
and patients will trust her
with their fears.

But I trusted her first.
Before the degree.
Before the title.

I gave her my chaos
and she didn't run.

That's not a doctor.
That's a miracle
with a medical license.

18. Fan

I am a fan.

Not the kind that cools —
the kind that stands
in the back of the arena
and cries when she walks in.

The kind that memorizes
her set list,
knows every lyric
to the song of her life,
and sings along
from the nosebleed seats
hoping she can hear.

Population of her fan club: one.
Dedication level: infinite.
Chances of being noticed:
small.

But I'm still here.
Front row in spirit.
Always.

19. 9:14 PM

9:14 PM.
I called.
You didn't answer.

And in the silence
between the last ring
and the voicemail,

I lived an entire life —

one where you picked up
and we talked until
your battery died,

one where you texted back
"2 mins"
and I waited
like it was Christmas morning,

one where you never called back
and I learned
what missing someone
who's still alive feels like.

Then — you called back.

And every imagined life collapsed
into the only one that mattered.

The one where I hear your voice.

20. I Don't Want This Call to End

42 minutes.

That's how long
we talked about nothing.

About mangoes that cost 400 rupees.
About a teacher who yelled
at me for smiling.
About a friend whose heart
was quietly breaking.

42 minutes.

And when you said goodbye —
REM sleep, surususuppa,
erumai maari fast-aa —

I held the phone
against my chest
like it still had
your warmth in it.

I don't want this call to end.
I don't want any moment
with you in it
to ever stop happening.

21. Jealous of the Air

I am jealous of the air
that gets to live inside your lungs.

I am jealous of the pillow
that knows the weight of your head
at 2 AM.

I am jealous of the stethoscope
that gets to hear
every heartbeat
I would die for.

I am jealous of Madurai
for holding your laughter
for a weekend.

I am jealous of the songs
that get to be
your background music
when I can't be
your foreground.

But most of all —
I am jealous of the you
who doesn't know
how extraordinary she is.

22. The Art of Waiting

I have become fluent
in the language of waiting.

Waiting for her call.
Waiting for her text.
Waiting for the read receipt.
Waiting for the typing dots.
Waiting for the day
she says my name
without adding "lOOsu" after.

But here's the secret
nobody tells you about waiting:

it's not empty time.
It's full.
Full of hope.
Full of imagining.
Full of love that has nowhere to go
so it fills you up instead.

*Every word in this book was written
by a boy who loves you without reason,
without condition, and without any plan to stop.*

Happy 22nd Birthday, Sanjana.

— Paartha

1. நீ பிறந்த நாள்

நீ பிறந்த நாளில்
உலகம் ஒரு புது நிறம் பெற்றது
காற்று கொஞ்சம் இனிமையாக மாறியது
நிலவு கொஞ்சம் பிரகாசமாக ஒளிர்ந்தது

உன் முதல் அழகை —
அது இசையா, மழையா
எனக்குத் தெரியாது
ஆனால் அன்றுதான்
என் வாழ்க்கையின் countdown ஆரம்பமானது

நீ இல்லாமல் 22 வருடம் வாழ்ந்தேன்
நீ இருக்கும் ஒரு நொடி —
அந்த 22 வருடத்தையும் மிஞ்சிவிட்டது

2. முன்னும் பின்னும்

உன் சிரிப்புக்குப் பின்னால்
ஒரு கடல் ஒளிந்திருக்கிறது
நீ காட்டாத கண்ணீர்
நான் கேட்காத வார்த்தைகள்

ஆனால் நான் தெரிந்துகொள்வேன்
உன் மௌனத்தின் மொழியை
ஏனெனில் காதல் என்பது
சொல்வது அல்ல — புரிந்துகொள்வது

3. என் இளமை நீ

நான் இழந்த சிரிப்பை
உன் முகத்தில் காண்கிறேன்
நான் மறந்த துணிச்சலை
உன் நடையில் காண்கிறேன்

மனச்சோர்வு திருடிய
என் இளமையின் நிழல்
உன்னில் உயிர்த்தெழுகிறது
ஒவ்வொரு நாளும்

நீ என் கண்ணாடி அல்ல —
நீ என் நேற்றைய நான்

4. உன் சிரிப்பு

உன் சிரிப்பு ஒரு மருந்து
மருத்துவரே அறியாத மருந்து

மாத்திரை தேவையில்லை
மருந்துக்கடை தேவையில்லை
நீ சிரித்தால் போதும் —
உலகமே குணமாகும்

"ஏய் சாவு அடிப்பேன்" என்று
நீ சொல்லும்போதே
என் நெஞ்சில் ஆயிரம்
பூக்கள் பூக்கின்றன

5. நிலவும் நீயும்

நிலவு உன் முகத்தைப் பார்த்து
பொறாமையில் மறைந்தது
நட்சத்திரங்கள் உன் கண்களைப் பார்த்து
வெட்கத்தில் மங்கின

உன் கழுத்தில் பிறை நிலவு —
அது என் காதலின் சின்னம்
உன் மேல் என்னை விட
யாரும் அன்பு காட்டி விடக்கூடாது
என்பதில் கொஞ்சம் பேராசை தான்

நிலவே நீ தான் —
மெல்ல வரும், மெல்ல ஒளிரும்,
மெல்ல என்னைக் கொல்லும்

6. கனவும் நிஜமும்

ஒன்பது வயதில் நீ கனவு கண்டாய்
"மருத்துவர் ஆவேன்" என்று
பத்தொன்பதில் அதை நிஜமாக்கினாய்

நான் கனவு கண்டேன்
"யாரோ ஒருத்தி என்னைக்
காதலிப்பாள்" என்று

நீ உன் கனவை நிஜமாக்கினாய்
என் கனவை நிஜமாக்குவாயா?

7. உன்னோடு வரும் பொம்மை

சிறிய கரடி ஒன்று
உன் பையில் வாழும்
அது நான் தான்
உருவம் மாறி

நீ வகுப்பறைக்குள் நுழையும்போது
நானும் நுழைவேன்
நீ மதுரை செல்லும்போது
நானும் வருவேன்

தொலைவில் இருந்தாலும்
உன் பக்கத்தில் இருக்கிறேன் —
ஒரு பொம்மையின் வடிவில்
ஆனால் முழு இதயத்துடன்

8. தீவிர ரசிகன்

விராட் கோஹ்லி என் ஹீரோ
The Weeknd என் பாடகன்
ஆனால் நீ — நீ என் எல்லாம்

உன் ஸ்நாப் — என் சினிமா
உன் போஸ்ட் — என் செய்தித்தாள்
உன் குரல் — என் பாடல்

ரசிகன் மன்றம் ஒன்று —
தலைவன் நான்
உறுப்பினர் நான்
ரசிகன் நான்

மக்கள் தொகை: ஒன்று
பக்தி: முடிவில்லாதது

9. உன் குரல்

உன் மூச்சு தொடும் தூரத்தில்
நான் இருக்க வேண்டும்
அந்த மூச்சைச் சுவாசித்து
நான் உயிர் வாழ வேண்டும்

"தூங்கு போ" என்கிறாய் —
தாலாட்டு கேட்கிறேன்
"அடிப்பேன்" என்கிறாய் —
காதல் பாட்டு கேட்கிறேன்

உன் குரல் இல்லாத நாள்
நாள் அல்ல —
வெறும் நேரம் மட்டுமே

10. தூரமும் நெருக்கமும்

பெங்களுர் முதல் உன் ஊர் வரை
எத்தனை கிலோமீட்டர் என்று
எனக்குத் தெரியாது

ஆனால் என் இதயம் முதல்
உன் இதயம் வரை —
தூரமே இல்லை

கடிதங்கள் பயணிக்கும்
குரல்கள் பயணிக்கும்
காதல் எல்லா எல்லைகளையும்
தாண்டிப் பயணிக்கும்

புவியியல் என்றும்
காதலைத் தடுத்ததில்லை

11. உன் அழகை நீ அறியாய்

24 மணி நேரமும் உன் நினைப்பு
இதில் என்ன வியப்பு?
என்னுள் இருந்து நினைப்பதே நீதானே

கண்ணாடி காட்டும் முகம் அல்ல —
நான் காணும் முகம் வேறு

ஃபுட்பால் விளையாடி விழும் முகம்
அதிகாலை 5 மணிக்கு தூங்கும் முகம்
"சாவு அடிப்பேன்" என்று
சிரித்தபடி சொல்லும் முகம்

அந்த முகம் —
உலகின் அழகான முகம்
நீ மட்டும் அதைப் பார்ப்பதில்லை

12. காத்திருத்தல்

கால் மணி நேரமாக இருந்தால் என்ன?
காலம் முழுவதுமாக இருந்தால் என்ன?

"காத்திருத்தல்" தானே காதல்!

உன் அழைப்புக்காகக் காத்திருக்கிறேன்
உன் பதிலுக்காகக் காத்திருக்கிறேன்
"உன் "ஏய் லூசு" என்ற
வார்த்தைக்காகக் காத்திருக்கிறேன்

காதலித்துக் கொண்டே தான் இருப்பேன்
காதல் தீரும் வரை அல்ல
காலம் முடியும் வரை!

13. காலைக் கனவு

காலையில் நீ எழும்போது
நான் அங்கே இருக்க வேண்டும்
காபி கொண்டு வர வேண்டும்
நெற்றியில் முத்தம் தர வேண்டும்

நீ "போடா" என்பாய் —
நான் மீண்டும் முத்தம் தருவேன்
நீ "லூசு" என்பாய் —
நான் மீண்டும் காபி தருவேன்

இது கனவா நிஜமா என்று
தெரியாத ஒரு நாள் வரும் —
அன்று நீ என் பக்கத்தில் இருப்பாய்
நான் உன் காலை நிலவாய் இருப்பேன்

14. மருந்தில்லா மருத்துவி

நீ படிப்பது மருத்துவம்
ஆனால் என்னைக் குணப்படுத்தியது
உன் இருப்பு

மாத்திரை தரவில்லை
ஊசி போடவில்லை
ஆனால் என் உடைந்த மனதை
உன் குரலால் ஒட்டினாய்

வெள்ளைக் கோட் அணியும் முன்னே
நீ ஏற்கனவே
ஒரு உயிரைக் காப்பாற்றிவிட்டாய் —

அது என் உயிர்

15. உயிர் ஊட்டும் உயிர்

உன் சக்தி தொற்றிக்கொள்ளும் —
எச்சரிக்கை!

நீ சிரித்தால் நானும் சிரிப்பேன்
நீ ஆடினால் என் மனமும் ஆடும்
நீ ஓடினால் என் இதயமும் ஓடும்

அறுபது வயது மனிதனாய்
வாழ்ந்து கொண்டிருந்தேன்
இருபத்தி நான்கு வயதில் —

நீ வந்தாய்
திரும்பவும் பதினெட்டு ஆனேன்
உன்னால்

16. உன் நினைவைத் தூக்கும் பாடல்கள்

ஒவ்வொரு பாடலிலும் நீ இருக்கிறாய் —

ரோஜா ரோஜா என்றால் உன் முகம்
அன்பே ஆருயிரே என்றால் உன் பெயர்
போ உறவே என்றால் — இல்லை,
இனி அது என் பாடல் அல்ல

இனி எல்லா பாடல்களும்
உன் பெயரில் தொடங்கும்
உன் சிரிப்பில் முடியும்

என் இசைப்பட்டியல் =
உன் நினைவுகளின் அருங்காட்சியகம்

17. மலரும் முட்களும்

பன்னிரண்டு வயதில்
ஒரு பூ மலர ஆரம்பிக்கிறது
இதழ்கள் மெல்ல விரிகின்றன
முட்கள் மெல்ல வளர்கின்றன

அழகும் ஆயுதமும்
ஒரே தண்டில் — அதுதான் நீ
யாரும் பறிக்க முடியாத ரோஜா
என் தோட்டத்தின் ராணி

18. பொறாமை

உன் அருகில் இருக்கும் காற்றின் மேல்
பொறாமை —
உன் கையில் இருக்கும் புத்தகத்தின் மேல்
பொறாமை —
உன் காதில் இருக்கும் கம்மல் மேல்
பொறாமை —

விக்கல் வந்தால் யாரோ நினைக்கிறார்கள்
என்பதில் எனக்கு நம்பிக்கை இல்லை —
ஆனால் உண்மை என்றால்
என்னவள் விக்கியே செத்திருப்பாள்

19. அவளுக்கு அவன்

உன் புத்தகங்களில் நீ மூழ்கியிருக்கையில்
என் கதையின் ஒரு பக்கம் எழுதப்பட்டது —
"ஒருநாள் இவனுக்கு
அவள் கிடைப்பாள்"

20. வெள்ளை அங்கி தேவதை

மருத்துவச் சாலையின் வாசலில்
வெள்ளை அங்கி அணிந்த தேவதை

உயிர்களைக் காக்கும் கைகள்
என் இதயத்தையும் காக்காதா?

நீ stethoscope வைத்து
இதயத் துடிப்பைக் கேட்கிறாய்
என் இதயத்தில் வைத்தால்
"Sanjana Sanjana" என்றே துடிக்கும்

அதை மட்டும் கேட்டுவிடாதே —
கேட்டால் திரும்பித் தர மறுப்பாய்

21. என் எல்லாம் நீ

நீ இல்லாத உலகம்
வெறும் புவியியல் மட்டுமே
நீ இருக்கும் உலகம்
என் வீடு

"Dustbin-la pottukoo" என்று சொல்வாய்
"Saavu adippEn" என்று மிரட்டுவாய்
ஆனால் உன் கண்கள் சொல்லும் —
"போகாதே" என்று

நான் போவதில்லை
போக இடமும் இல்லை
போக மனமும் இல்லை

நீதான் என் முகவரி
நீதான் என் தேடல்
நீதான் என் எல்லாம்

22. காரணமில்லாக் காதல்

கவிதையாக அல்ல
நாடகமாக அல்ல
சினிமா வசனமாக அல்ல

அலை கடலை நேசிப்பது போல —
தேர்வு இல்லை, திசை மட்டுமே

மூச்சு காற்றை நேசிப்பது போல —
விருப்பம் இல்லை, வாழ்வு மட்டுமே

காதலை கைவிட்ட ஒருவன்
மீண்டும் காதலை நம்ப வைத்தவளை
நேசிப்பது போல —

அதுதான் என் காதல்
காரணமின்றி
நிபந்தனையின்றி
முடிவின்றி

நான் உன்னை நேசிக்கிறேன், சஞ்சனா

என்றும் உன்னவன்,
பார்த்தா

இந்த 22 கவிதைகளும்
உனக்காக மட்டுமே,
என் காதலின் சாட்சியாக,
என் இதயத்தின் குரலாக.

காலம் கடந்தாலும்,
தூரம் பிரித்தாலும்,
இந்த வார்த்தைகள் நிலைக்கும் —
என் அன்பு போலவே.

— *Paartha*

I love loving you! But nee enna love pannanumnu naan sollala – All I want is to show you how I feel that's all! Samyuktha asked what if she(you) don't have any feelings for me or you reciprocate this – I realized then that I don't want you to do so! I just want this never ending mayakkam of loving you! I wanna do more than this but it'll be better if you are there here!

Etha pandrathaa irunthaalum itha full-ah padichitu pannu – veetlaiyo Jagan-taiyo maati vittudaatha seriya!

I don't know. But something in me wishes I was there, even as a stranger, just to see what seven-year-old Sanjana looked like. Because if she was anything like 21-year-old Sanjana — she would have been full of life, full of chaos, and impossible to ignore

You are luck, you are my music, you are my rainbow, you are my seven oceans

My intentions with you are as follow:

“செல்லக் கிளி என்னை குளிப்பிக்க வேண்டும்
சேலைத் தலைப்பில் துவட்டிட வேண்டும்

கல்லு சிலை போலே நீ நிற்க வேண்டும்
கண்கள் பார்த்துத் தலைவார வேண்டும்

நீ வந்து இலை போட வேண்டும்
நான் வந்து பரிமாற வேண்டும்
என் இமை உன் விழி மூட வேண்டும்
இருவரும் ஒரு சுவரம் பாட வேண்டும்
உன்னில் என்னைத் தேட வேண்டும்

புத்தம் புது மலரே
என் ஆசை சொல்லவா

கன்னி உந்தன் மடி சாய வேண்டும்
கம்பன் வரிகள் நீ சொல்ல வேண்டும்
உன்னைக் கட்டிக்கொண்டு தூங்க வேண்டும்
உந்தன் விரல் தலை கோதிட வேண்டும்
கண்ணோடு இதம் காண வேண்டும்
கண்ணீரில் குளிர் காய வேண்டும்

உதட்டுக்கும் உதட்டுக்கும் தூரம் வேண்டும்
உயிருக்குள் உயிருக்குள் சென்று சேர வேண்டும்
தாயாய் சேயாய் மாற வேண்டும்

புத்தம் புது மலரே
என் ஆசை சொல்லவா
பொத்தி வைத்து மறைத்தேன்
என் பாஷை சொல்லவா
இதயம் திறந்து கேட்கிறேன்
என்னதான் தருவாய் பார்க்கிறேன்
நெஞ்சுக்குள்ளே என்னென்னமோ நினைத்தேன்
நித்தம் நித்தம் கற்பனைகள் வளர்த்தேன்
தவித்தேன்"

Song : Putham Puthu Malare from Amaravathi

I want to be with you in all your birthdays that are yet to come and I wish I was there in every past ones! Idk why but I love you again!

"ஒரு அகதியை போல் அலைகிறேன்,
உன் இதயத்தில் இடம் கிடைக்காதா என்று!
எந்நாளும் உன்னையே பின்தொடர்கிறேன்,
நீ சுவாசித்த காற்றையாவது சுவாசிக்கலாம் என்று!
**உலகில் எல்லா கண்ணாடிகளை விடவும்,
உன்னை அழகாக பிரதிபலிப்பவன் நான்தான்.**" (ennamaaaa eluthiirukaanga la)

Poem from Kadhalar Dhinam (1999)

Please ennai oru agathiyaaa serthuko!

Bye

Please read everything completely when you are free, Sorry in advance I know that you have exam but whenever you are bored read this!

Piggy @ Partha

"I wrap around you like a hug that never lets go, Inside me, something that once bloomed still glows. A garden froze in time just to stay on your wrist — What am I, that nature and love have kissed?"

"I hang close to your heart, shaped like the night sky's smile, Inside me, a garden sleeps in a space so small. You love the moon — now it carries a flower's soul. What am I, that holds two beautiful things in one?"

"I'm small enough to carry, soft enough to hold, I guard a tiny key but no door to unfold. The key doesn't open a lock — it opens something deeper. What am I, your pocket-sized little keeper?"

"I'll be the first thing you touch every single morning, A girl who looks like you lives on my surface, smiling. Your name is written where the world can see — What am I, that makes your phone scream 'this belongs to me'?"

"I'm bigger than your maadu probably but twice as soft to squeeze, I'll sit beside your bed and hold your dreams with ease. When he can't be there to hug you through the night, I'll be his stand-in — what am I, holding you tight?"

"I look like a memory frozen still in time, but touch me and I'll sing — a melody, not a mime. A picture that has a heartbeat, a frame that has a voice — What am I, where sight and sound become one choice?"